***Board 1***
West Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ K Q 7 3<br>♥ A 4<br>♦ Q 9 6 2<br>♣ A 8 4 | |
| ♠ J 10 9 6 4<br>♥ 9 8 3 2<br>♦ —<br>♣ Q 10 6 3 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ 8<br>♥ K Q 10 7 5<br>♦ 10 8 4<br>♣ J 9 5 2 |
| | ♠ A 5 2<br>♥ J 6<br>♦ A K J 7 5 3<br>♣ K 7 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pass | 1NT | Pass | 3♦ |
| Pass | 4♦ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♥[2] | Pass | 7NT |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

7NT by North
Lead: ♥K

North is to play 7NT. East leads the ♥K, dummy plays the ♥6 and West the ♥2.

With 12 obvious tricks your first thought should be that perhaps the ♠s will split 3-3.

Then, your second thought should be that dummy's ♥J is a Threat against East's ♥Q, so if it is East who holds 4 ♠s you will be able to squeeze him.

Since the contract is 7NT you take the first trick with the ♥A.

With one trick in the bag you should test ♦s next. When you play the ♦A West discards a ♠.

You continue with the ♦Q and ♦ K, West discarding a ♥ and a ♣.

Since West has shown up with a ♦ void he has become the odds-on favorite to hold the ♠ Guard. His ♠ discard makes it very likely that he started with 5 ♠s.

To find out for sure you play ♠A, then ♠Q. Sure enough East discards a ♥ on the second round.

You can't squeeze East in ♥s and ♠s because he doesn't hold the ♠ Guard, West does.

But now a completely new possibility shows up. Say to yourself, over and over, "East must guard ♥s, and West must guard ♠s. Nobody can guard ♣s."

You start playing dummy's ♦ winners.

With one more ♦ in dummy, things look like this.

West discards the ♣6.

When you play the ♦5 West must keep both ♠s to guard against your ♠7. So he discards the ♣6, hoping partner can stop that suit.

Your ♠7 is now worthless so you throw it.

East has no problem, (yet), he discards the ♥10.

It is now time to pressure East.

Play dummy's ♠5 to your ♠K.

East MUST keep his ♥Q so he releases his ♣5.

And you win the last three tricks with ♣K, ♣A, ♣8.

This is called a Double Squeeze.

***Board 2***
East Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 6<br>♥ Q 9 8 4 3<br>♦ 8 5 2<br>♣ J 9 7 5 | |
| ♠ 9 5 2<br>♥ 6<br>♦ A J 9 7 4<br>♣ Q 8 4 3 | | ♠ A K 7 4<br>♥ A K 5<br>♦ K Q 10<br>♣ A K 2 |
| | ♠ Q J 10 8 3<br>♥ J 10 7 2<br>♦ 6 3<br>♣ 10 6 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | 2♣ | Pass |
| 3♦ | Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass |
| 5♦[2] | Pass | 7NT | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

7NT by East
Lead: ♠Q

East is to play 7NT. South leads the ♠Q.

One more winner is needed. Dummy's fourth ♣ is a possibility.

So take the ♠K and play ♣ A K Q.

South discards a ♠ on the third ♣.

Now you know North guards the ♣s.

Before tackling ♦s, see what you can discover about ♠s.

Play the ♠A. North discards a ♥.

North guards the ♣s. South guards the ♠s. Nobody can guard the ♥s.

Play 4 rounds of ♦s.

On the fourth ♦ North had to discard a ♥. You discarded a small ♠. South discarded a ♠ on the third ♦ and a ♥ on the fourth.

North discards a ♥.

You play dummy's ♦4. North cannot throw the ♣J or he will set up dummy's ♣8, so he discards a ♥.

You discard the ♠7.

Now South is squeezed. He cannot discard the ♠J or he will set up dummy's ♠9, so he discards a ♥.

You win the last three ♥ tricks with another Double Squeeze.

***Board 3***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 10 8 7 3<br>♥ Q 10<br>♦ K Q 6<br>♣ A 9 7 5 | |
| ♠ A K J 9 4<br>♥ 6 4<br>♦ 10 7 2<br>♣ Q 10 2 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ Q 6 2<br>♥ 7 5 2<br>♦ J 9 8 4 3<br>♣ J 4 |
| | ♠ 5<br>♥ A K J 9 8 3<br>♦ A 5<br>♣ K 8 6 3 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| 1♠ | 2♣ | Pass | 3♥ |
| Pass | 4♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♦[2] | Pass | 6♥ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠A

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠A, then ♠K.

When you looked at just your and dummy's cards on the previous page it may have looked impossible to find a twelfth winner.

Even looking at all four hands here it is still very difficult to come up with a plan.

Here's a hint: If West holds 3 ♣s, (and you see that he does), can you squeeze him in ♣s and ♠s?

Of course you ruffed the ♠K.

The big problem with trying to squeeze West in the black suits right now is that East actually holds a ♠ guard. But you can fix that.

You draw two rounds of trumps with dummy's ♥Q and ♥10.

East plays the ♠Q and you ruff. Then you pull the last trump.

Now play the ♦A, ♦K, and ♦Q, discarding the ♣3 from your hand.

Then lead dummy's ♣7 to your ♣K.

Here you are in your hand.

Only West can guard dummy's ♠10, and only West can guard dummy's♣9.

West discards the ♣10, holding on to the ♠J.

You play your ♥A and West must give up one of his guards. If he holds on to the ♠J then you toss dummy's useless ♠10. If he throws the ♠J then you toss dummy's ♣9.

***Board 4***
West Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A K 9 3 2<br>♥ 10 4 2<br>♦ J 9<br>♣ J 6 4 | |
| ♠ J 7 4<br>♥ A 7<br>♦ K 7 5 2<br>♣ A K 7 3 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ Q 10<br>♥ K Q 5 3<br>♦ A 8 6 3<br>♣ 8 5 2 |
| | ♠ 8 6 5<br>♥ J 9 8 6<br>♦ Q 10 4<br>♣ Q 10 9 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1NT | Pass | 2♣ | Pass |
| 2♦ | Pass | 3NT | |
| All Pass | | | |

3NT by West
Lead: ♠3

West is to play 3NT. North leads the ♠3. South plays the ♠5.

From the opening lead of ♠3 and South's play of ♠5 you should have deduced that North held five ♠s to the A K. Therefore if you lose a trick in any other suit North will be able to take 4 ♠ tricks and defeat you.

You have 8 winners, and if South holds 4+ ♥s AND 3+ ♦s then only he can guard the two suits.

But how can you squeeze him?

Dummy's ♠10 won the first trick.

The answer to that question is that **YOU** cannot squeeze him.

But maybe you can make his partner do the job for you.

At trick 2 you play a ♠.

Of course North will win this with his ♠K.

And he will no doubt continue with the ♠A and ♠9.

North continues with the ♠A and the ♠9; dummy discards two ♦s.

You discard 2 ♦s from dummy and a ♣ from your hand.

South cannot spare either a ♥ or a ♦ so he also throws a ♣.

***Remember this position***

North will almost surely cash his ♠2.

North cashes the ♠2; dummy discards a ♣ and South the ♣Q.

You and dummy both discard a ♣ and South also must discard a ♣.

It doesn't matter what North plays next, lets say it is a ♣.

You are in your hand with the ♣K.

You play the ♣A.

South is truly squeezed. If he discards a ♥, dummy's ♥5 will become a winner. but if he discards a ♦ then you will get a third ♦ trick and the contract.

Since it was North who started the squeeze by cashing his last ♠, this is called a Suicide Squeeze.**BUT**, what if North had not cashed that ♠?

***Board 5***
North Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A<br>♥ A 6 3<br>♦ K 5<br>♣ A K Q J 9 8 7 | |
| ♠ 10 7 5 4 2<br>♥ J 10 2<br>♦ Q 10 4 3<br>♣ 4 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ K Q 9 6 3<br>♥ Q 9 8 5<br>♦ 9<br>♣ 10 6 2 |
| | ♠ J 8<br>♥ K 7 4<br>♦ A J 8 7 6 2<br>♣ 5 3 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 2♣ | Pass | 3♦ |
| Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♦[2] |
| Pass | 5NT[3] | Pass | 6♦[4] |
| Pass | 7♣ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace
3. asks for kings
4. 1 king

7♣ by North
Lead: ♠K

North is to play 7♣. East leads the ♠K.

At first glance this doesn't appear to be a difficult hand. You expect to win the opening lead, pull trumps, then establish a ♦ winner by playing ♦K, ♦A, and ruffing a ♦. As long as they split 3-2 you could reach dummy's ♦ winner with the ♥K.

So you take the ♠A, pull three rounds of trumps and play ♦K.

But when you lead to the ♦A East discards a small ♠.

Time to rethink. You are in dummy now, and you can ruff a ♦, return with the ♥K and ruff another ♦. The last ♦ would be good but you'd have no way to reach it.

Think squeeze instead.

You ruff a ♦. This turns the ♦J into a Threat card against West's ♦Q.

But, the ♠J is already a Threat card against East's ♠Q.

You play your ♣J.

Play your ♣J and ♣9, discarding the ♦8 and the ♥4 from dummy.

East can afford to discard the ♠9 and the ♥5.

West can spare his two ♠s.

You are there.

East gives up the ♥8.

Your ♣8 does it.

East cannot throw the ♠Q, so he gives up the ♥8. Dummy's ♠J is of no further value so you dump it.

West cannot throw the ♦Q, so he gives up the ♥2.

And you take the last three tricks with the ♥ suit. There were only two defenders; one of them had to guard ♠s and the other had to guard ♦s. There was nobody left to guard ♥s.

***Board 6***
East Deals
E-W Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 10 9 7<br>♥ 4<br>♦ Q J 9 4 2<br>♣ J 10 9 3 | |
| ♠ Q 4<br>♥ J 9 7 3<br>♦ K 7 5<br>♣ 8 6 5 2 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ —<br>♥ A K Q 10 5<br>♦ A 8 6 3<br>♣ A K Q 4 |
| | ♠ A K J 8 6 5 3 2<br>♥ 8 6 2<br>♦ 10<br>♣ 7 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | 2♣ | 4♠ |
| Pass | Pass | 5♥ | Pass |
| 6♥ | | | |
| All Pass | | | |

6♥ by East
Lead: ♠A

East is to play 6♥. South leads the ♠A.

If ♦s and ♣s split nicely this would be an easy slam. But with that wild ♠ bid by South you can't expect decent splits.

So you ruff the ♠, pull trumps in three rounds, then play ♣ A K and get the bad news when South discards a ♠.

You now know that North guards the ♣s. And since South had 3 ♥s and a very long ♠ suit it is pretty likely that North guards the ♦s also. You will try to squeeze North in ♣s and ♦s, but first you must lose a trick to rectify the count.

South plays the ♦10.

So you play a low ♦ from each hand.

It doesn't matter which defender takes the ♦, since either one is going to do the same thing. Assume South wins the ♦10.

He will then play the ♠K, which you must ruff in your hand.

South discards.

A small ♦ to dummy's ♦K.

You are in dummy, ready for the squeeze.

You play dummy's ♥J.

North gets to choose his own fate - discarding a protector in one of the two suits. Of course, whichever suit he discards you will throw the opposite one.

Yet another slam, courtesy of the Squeeze Play!